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New Zealand pacer and former captain Tim Southee will retire from Test cricket after the upcoming three-match Test series at home against England. He has played 104 Tests for New Zealand and taken 385 wickets. He is the most successful Kiwi bowler across formats with 770 scalps — he is the only player in the world to take more than 300 Test wickets, 200 ODI wickets and 100 T20I wickets. Southee will be available for selection if New Zealand qualifies for the World Test Championship (WTC) final next June.

AFP



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After conceding the ODI series 1-2 to West Indies, England bounced back to clinch the five-match T20I series 3-1. Skipper Jos Buttler, returning from injury, led England to an unassailable 3-0 lead in the T20I series, backed by pacer Saqib Mahmood's impressive nine wickets, which restricted the hosts to below-par totals. Although West Indies secured a consolation win in the fourth T20I by successfully chasing down a mammoth 219-run target, the series finale was washed out. In the ODI series earlier, Liam Livingstone captained England and played a significant role by scoring an unbeaten 124 in the second match, helping England chase down 329 to level the series. Despite this, West Indies excelled in the series decider, with Brandon King and Keacy Carty's 225-run partnership enabling them to chase down a middling total.

GETTY IMAGES



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Azmatullah Omarzai's all-round brilliance handed Afghanistan a 2-1 ODI series win against Bangladesh in Sharjah. Omarzai picked four wickets to restrict Bangladesh to 244 for eight before smashing an unbeaten 77-ball 70 to guide his team home with five wickets in hand and 10 balls to spare. The Afghans had taken a 1-0 lead in the series after Bangladesh suffered a spectacular collapse, triggered by off-spinner AM Ghazanfar, as it lost eight wickets for 23 runs, falling short by 92 runs while chasing 236. The Tigers squared the series by winning the second ODI by 68 runs, but the Afghans had the last laugh.

GETTY IMAGES



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Lockie Ferguson picked a hat-trick across two overs to help New Zealand defend 108 runs in the second T20I against Sri Lanka as the two-match series ended in a 1-1 stalemate. In the first T20I, Sri Lanka, wobbling at 87 for five, rode on skipper Charith Asalanka's unbeaten 35 to chase down New Zealand's 135 with an over to spare.

AP



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Afghanistan all-rounder Mohammad Nabi announced his decision to retire from One-Day Internationals after next year's Champions Trophy. The 39-year-old has featured in 167 ODIs since 2009, scoring 3,600 runs in 167 matches, including two centuries and 17 fifties. He picked up 172 wickets, including four four-wicket hauls and a fiver (5/17). Afghanistan qualified for the Champions Trophy after it finished in sixth place during last year's ODI World Cup in India. It will be Afghanistan's first-ever appearance in the eight-team competition.

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